

Alexandra Catherine Montgomery-Whitfield

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San Francisco Bay Area, California, United States

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/alexandra-catherine-montgomery-whitfield-engineer>

Principal software engineer and engineering leader with 12+ years of experience architecting distributed systems, leading large teams, and shipping consumer and enterprise products at scale. Deep expertise across frontend, backend, infrastructure, and platform engineering. A pragmatic technologist who pairs long-term architectural vision with relentless execution. Reachable at <https://averylongportfoliourlthatdoesnotbreaknicely.example.com/portfolio/work/2024> for a full case-study archive.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages

TypeScript JavaScript Python Go Rust Java Kotlin Ruby C++ SQL

Frontend

React Next.js Vue Svelte Tailwind CSS Redux React Query Webpack Vite Storybook

Backend

Node.js Express NestJS GraphQL gRPC PostgreSQL MongoDB Redis Kafka RabbitMQ

Cloud and DevOps

AWS GCP Azure Docker Kubernetes Terraform Pulumi GitHub Actions Prometheus Grafana

Practices

Distributed Systems Architecture and Design Event-Driven Microservices Domain-Driven Design Observability Site Reliability Engineering

Leadership

Team Building Mentorship Technical Strategy Cross-functional Collaboration Hiring and Interviewing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Software Engineer and Technical Lead

2021-06 - Present

Hyperscale Cloud Infrastructure Corporation

San Francisco, CA

- Achievement 1: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.
- Achievement 2: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.
- Achievement 3: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.
- Led a cross-functional initiative spanning multiple teams and time zones, coordinating engineering, design, and product stakeholders to deliver a high-availability platform serving millions of monthly active users while reducing infrastructure cost by a measurable margin and improving p95 latency across critical paths.
- Achievement 5: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.
- Achievement 6: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.

- Achievement 7: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.

Staff Software Engineer

2019-01 - 2021-05

Meridian Financial Technologies

New York, NY

- Achievement 1: shipped, measured, and iterated on a meaningful improvement that moved a key business metric and was adopted across the wider organisation.
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Senior Full-Stack Engineer

2016-08 - 2018-12

Nimbus Analytics

Remote

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Software Engineer II

2014-03 - 2016-07

BrightPath Software Solutions and Consulting Group International

Austin, TX

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Founding Engineer

2012-09 - 2014-02

StartupForge

Palo Alto, CA

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Junior Developer (no achievements listed)

Legacy Systems Inc.

2011-06 - 2012-08

Boston, MA

Engineering Intern

Internship Co.

2010-06 - 2010-09

Seattle, WA

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SELECTED PROJECTS

Open-Source Distributed Job Scheduler

<https://github.com/alexandra-mw/distributed-scheduler>

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Real-Time Collaborative Document Engine with CRDT Conflict Resolution

<https://crdt-docs.example.com>

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Project Without Any Description (edge case)

<https://no-description.example.com>

Personal Site Generator

<https://github.com/alexandra-mw/site-gen>

- A small static-site generator written in Go with incremental builds and a plugin system.

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2009 - 2011

Master of Science in Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence

Cambridge, MA

- Thesis on fault-tolerant consensus in geo-distributed databases
- Graduate Teaching Assistant for Distributed Systems
- GPA 3.9 / 4.0

University of California, Berkeley

2005 - 2009

Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

Berkeley, CA

- Graduated summa cum laude
- President of the ACM student chapter

CERTIFICATIONS AND AWARDS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional
- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)
- Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)
- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert
- Distinguished Engineering Award, 2023
- Hackathon Grand Prize Winner, Global Cloud Summit, 2022

SPEAKING AND PUBLICATIONS

- Keynote: Designing Resilient Systems at Planet Scale - Global Cloud Summit 2023.
- Conference talk: The Pragmatic Path to Microservices - QCon San Francisco 2022.
- Co-author of a widely cited paper on consensus protocols in geo-distributed databases.
- Regular contributor to several popular open-source infrastructure projects.
- Led a cross-functional initiative spanning multiple teams and time zones, coordinating engineering, design, and product stakeholders to deliver a high-availability platform serving millions of monthly active users while reducing infrastructure cost by a measurable margin and improving p95 latency across critical paths.

LANGUAGES

- English (Native)
- Spanish (Fluent)
- French (Professional)
- German (Conversational)
- Mandarin (Basic)

ADDITIONAL LINKS OR DATA

Portfolio: <https://alexandra.dev>

GitHub: <https://github.com/alexandra-mw>

Case Studies: <https://averylongportfoliourlthatdoesnotbreaknicely.example.com/case-studies>

X / Twitter: @alexandra_mw